



THE INSTITUTE OF
MASTERS
of WINE

Stage one assessment (S1A) 2025

Practical paper

Question 1

Wines 1-3 come from three different countries.

For each wine:

- Identify the origin as closely as possible making reference to grape variety/ies. (3 x 11 marks)
- Comment on method of production making particular reference to oak. (3 x 7 marks)
- Comment on quality in the context of the region of origin. (3 x 7 marks)

Question 2

Wines 4 and 5 are from the same region of origin.

For both wines:

- Identify the origin as closely as possible. (12 marks)
- Comment on winemaking. (18 marks)
- Compare and contrast style and quality. (20 marks)

Question 3

Wines 6-8 are made from the same single grape variety and are from three different countries.

For all three wines:

- Identify the grape variety. (21 marks)

For each wine:

- Identify the origin as closely as possible. (3 x 8 marks)
- Comment on quality within the context of the region of origin. (3 x 10 marks)

Question 4

Wines 9-12 are from four different countries.

For each wine:

- Identify the origin as closely as possible making reference to grape variety/ies used. (4 x 9 marks)
- Comment on the key methods of production. (4 x 12 marks)
- State ABV in % (4 x 2 marks)
- State RS in g/l (4 x 2 marks)

Wines

1. Domaine de Chevalier Blanc Pessac Leognan, 2021. Bordeaux, France. (13.5%)

2. Barefoot Buttery Chardonnay, NV. USA. (13.5%)
3. Shaw and Smith M3 Chardonnay, 2022. Adelaide Hills, Australia. (13%)
4. Corte Sant'Alda Valpolicella Amarone, 2016. Veneto, Italy. (15.5%)
5. Allegrini Valpolicella, 2022. Veneto, Italy. (13%)
6. Felton Road Bannockburn Pinot Noir, 2022. Central Otago, New Zealand. (14%)
7. Maison Roisin Curley, Bourgogne Rouge, 2022. Burgundy, France. (13%)
8. Sandhi Santa Rita Hills, 2022. California, USA. (13%)
9. Disznókő Tokaji 5 Puttonyos, 2013. Tokaj, Hungary. (12%)
10. Henriques & Henriques Malvasia 10 years old, NV. Madeira, Portugal. (20%)
11. Klein Constantia, Vin de Constance, 2019. Constantia, South Africa. (14%)
12. Gonzalez Byass Leonor Palo Cortado, 12 years old. Jerez, Spain. (20%)

Theory paper

Two questions to be answered, **one** from Section A and **one** from Section B.

Section A

Question 1

What effects do vineyard pests have on grape quality, and how do grape growers control them?
(Paper 1)

Section B

Question 2

Outline the most important quality control checks during bottling and why each is necessary.
(Paper 3)

Question 3

What are the advantages and disadvantages of private-label wines for wineries, distributors and retailers? (Paper 4)